

**1**

Dungeon  
Master

**2-6**

Players

# Clue

a game by Megan Wittorp

## Official Rules and Gameplay



## Set Up

- 1. Players:** Pick characters and place on respective spaces.
- 2. DM:** Shuffle the nine clue cards and place facedown in a pile on top of the castle.
- 3. DM:** Separate remaining cards into three decks: characters, weapons, and rooms. Shuffle each deck and remove the top card of each deck without showing the players. You can choose whether or not to view these. Place these three cards in the envelope — these are the “who”, “with what”, and “where” cards. Place the envelope below the clue cards on the board.
- 4. DM:** Shuffle the remaining character, weapon, and room cards into one deck. Remove four random cards and place them in four random rooms of your choice. Deal the remaining cards face down into a number of decks equal to number of players. It's okay if some decks have more cards than others (this will be useful in the next step).
- 5.** All players roll 1d20 for **intelligence**. Without viewing the decks' contents, the player with the highest roll can have first pick of the dealt decks. If there is a deck(s) with more cards than others, they pick from the deck(s) with the most cards. Players continue to pick their deck, going in order of highest roll to lowest. The lowest roll will receive the deck with fewest cards.
- 6.** All players take a note sheet. Mark each player's initials (including your own) at the top.
- 7.** Secretly look at your cards and mark them on your sheet. These ones cannot be in the envelope! Keep your sheet a secret.
- 8.** Every player roll initiative prior to game start. If there is a tie, the player with higher dexterity goes first. The order of initiative will be used all game.

## Play

- 1.** The player with the highest initiative roll goes first, and gameplay will go in order of the initiative rolled at the beginning of the game — highest to lowest.
- 2.** The amount of spaces you can move is equal to your character's speed with each tile representing 5 feet. You can move as many spaces as desired at your speed. Diagonal movements work in that the first diagonal movement is 5 feet, the next consecutive one is 10 feet, the next 5 feet, and so on.
- 3.** On your turn, do **one** of three things:
  - Move your character based on the movement rules mentioned above. Try to get to a room.
  - Use a secret passage at the start of your turn to move to a connected room.
  - Stay in the room you are already in.
- 4.** If you choose to land on a magnifying glass icon, draw a clue card. Read aloud and do as it says. Place in a discard pile off of the board. This card, nor this magnifying glass space, can be used again. Use a small token to mark that this spot is no longer an active clue space and now acts as a regular tile.
- 5.** If you move to a room with a card in it, you have encountered a monster. Your goal is to somehow defeat the monster to gain that card. See the **combat** section for directions on how to handle monster encounters as both player and DM.
  - Whoever defeats or makes the final blow to the monster gets to add the card to their hand and any other players who participate in combat get to see the card before it goes in that player's hand.
- 6.** If you reach or stay in a room, make a suggestion for whodunit, with what, and where. Say, “I suggest **[any**

**character]**, with **[any weapon]**, in **[the room you are in]**. This can be done before or after combat.

- The player to your left **secretly** shows you one of the cards from your suggestion, if they have it.
- If they have more than one, they can choose which card to show you.
- If they do not have a card to show you, then the next player secretly shows you a card from your suggestion and so on.
- No one has a card? It's either on the board or you have cracked the case!

**7. Mark your sheet** with the card you were shown — it can't be in the envelope. If you weren't shown a card, it's either one of the protected cards on the board or could be the truth to the case!

## Combat

1. One way for combat to occur is when you choose to fight a monster that is guarding a card. The difficulty of the monster will be based on how many people are in the room where combat is occurring and the two rows of tiles which surround that room.
  - If you do not wish to fight the monster, you can attempt animal handling if it is an animal, or try to use persuasion, deception, or intimidation. If you roll higher than the DM and succeed at any of these attempts, you can gain the card from that room and have to show to any other players **in** the room.
2. **DM:** When someone chooses to engage in combat, count how many characters are in the room where combat is to occur and also the characters in the two rows of tiles surrounding the room (see example on next page). The total number of characters in this space will determine the monster's difficulty.

- **1-2 characters:** medium difficulty
- **3-4 characters:** hard difficulty
- **5-6 characters:** deadly difficulty

3. **DM:** Pick any monster of the applicable difficulty. Each monster can only be used once per game. Roll initiative for the monster and fit it accordingly into the initiative order determined at the game start.
4. During combat, turns will continue in the same order, allowing players who are not in combat to continue the game elsewhere on the board.
5. Using your character's abilities, fight the monster using basic Dungeons & Dragons combat tactics. They can vary based on DM. New to DnD? Feel free to ask the DM for help with combat!
6. When in a room, there is no range limit or movement taken into account. Assume you are always close or far enough from the monster to make your attacks.
7. There can also be player vs player combat during the game but damage is halved.
8. To regain health, you can choose to not make an suggestion in a room and instead roll 1d4.
9. **Do not die.** If your HP hits zero, your character will die and you will no longer be able to continue. If you need health in combat, you will need to disengage (say this out loud before doing so), go to another room, and forfeit your suggestion to roll for HP.



## Win

Once you think you know whodunit, you can make your accusation! You can only make **one** accusation per game, and it must be **on your turn**, but it can be right after you make a suggestion. You have to be in a room but don't have to be in the room you're going to name.

1. Say, "I accuse **[character]**, with **[weapon]**, in **[room]**."
2. Secretly open the envelope. Are all three cards you named inside?
  - **Yes! You win!** Congratulations on solving the case!
  - **No! Oh no, you're wrong!** Without letting anyone see, put the cards back in the envelope. You can't take anymore turns, but you must show cards when other players make a suggestion. The game continues until someone makes a correct accusation. If no one does, the murderer gets away!

## Notes

- **DM:** Feel free to make up your own unofficial rules. It's just as much a game of DnD as it is Clue. Use your DM powers as you see fit.
- **Players:** You can interact with each other through the game as well! Since it is still DnD, you can still roleplay your characters and use your skills to mess with one another.
- This game can have as much immersion as you want. The board is just a map. Create the world, roleplay, build on the story! It's your game!

## Story

You, the players, are all sacred advisors to The King and are considered his closest allies in the kingdom. He trusts each of you to provide him with powerful insights about his domain and help him to make decisions that benefit his people.

Lately, The King has grown paranoid that someone within his castle is leaking information to enemy kingdoms and his land may soon come under attack. He can only trust his advisors now.

Unfortunately, this unwavering trust will be his **demise**.

One dark and stormy night, The King is lured from his castle under the premise of someone in the land having secret information from opposing forces. He is seen rushing off under the pouring rain but never returns...

The next morning, The King's body is found dead on the steps of his castle, any signs of muddy footprints washed away by the torrential downpour the previous night. Quickly, the advisors are called upon as the only loyal forces able solve this horrible crime.

It soon becomes clear, though, that The King would only have left under such circumstances if it was for someone he trusted implicitly, which means his killer must be **one of his advisors**.

As the advisors turn against each other, all loyalty being questioned, you must investigate the attack and bring the traitor to **justice**!